

Zen Sushi Omakase

Weekly Competitive & Trend Data

Peer IG/TikTok content coverage from recent weeks, newly opened Manhattan omakase, the five hottest recent omakase posts, and what the broader NYC food scene is running right now. Pure data — no judgments, no advice.

00	Data Sources & Method	What you can / can't see · how to read freshness
01	Peer Content Coverage	Shinzo / Kawa / Mojo East / SourAji
02	New Manhattan Omakase	5 openings in the past 60 days
03	5 Hottest Recent Posts	NYC omakase scope
04	NYC Overall Food Trends	Recent openings + TikTok topics

BRIEF TYPE	TIME WINDOW	COVERAGE
Pure data — no recommendations, analysis, or strategy	Recent (past 1–4 weeks; strict "7-day" resolution unavailable)	4 peers · 5 new openings · 5 viral posts · NYC trends

DATA CURRENT AS OF MAY 29, 2026 · LATEST PUBLICLY INDEXED · WEEKLY CADENCE · MAY LAG REAL TIME ~1-2 WEEKS

RESTAURANT INTELLIGENCE • MAY 29, 2026 • WEEK 22

Data Sources & Method

Before reading the data, here is what this report can and cannot see — so nothing gets over-interpreted.

Methodology: Based on publicly indexed data visible to Google — Google Search, Yelp/Resy/Tock descriptions, restaurant official sites, the TikTok discover page, public Instagram bios and post titles, and aggregators (Eater NY, Time Out NY, Infatuation, Patch, HelpNewYork, The Sushi Legend).

✓ Can confirm

- Official accounts exist, follower counts, bios
- TikTok videos indexed by Google (titles, tags, likes)
- Opening dates / chef backgrounds reported by aggregator media
- Content themes repeatedly referenced recently
- Menus and pricing shown on Yelp / Resy / Google

✗ Can't see clearly

- Strict "past 7 days" IG/TikTok posts (index lags 1-2 weeks)
- Each restaurant's own daily post details (no API)
- Precise post timestamps
- Content "quietly posted but never went viral" / not indexed
- Distinguishing paid/boosted posts from organic reach

HOW TO READ THE DATA

"Weekly" is the cadence this brief arrives on — not a promise every figure is from the last seven days. Each data point is the most recent the public index shows, shown with the date it was observed so you can judge how fresh it is. Every field follows one of three states:

Found & current	Reported with the date observed — e.g. "78.7K followers (as of May 29)."
Only older data found	The latest available is shown, dated and labeled as such — never silently passed off as this week.
No public footprint	Marked "No public data found." Nothing is estimated, rounded in, or invented to fill the gap.

Note: "Recent" below means observable content over the past 1-4 weeks. Strict "past 7 days" resolution requires a paid scraper (Apify, Bright Data, etc.), roughly \$50-200/month — a post-MVP capability. A stale-but-sourced figure is reported (and dated); a figure that isn't publicly findable is marked not found, not guessed.

Peer IG / TikTok Coverage

Four recent omakase neighbors — what each posts, what gets posted about them, and how they position. Pure description; figures dated as observed.

Shinzo Omakase		IG @shinzo_omakase · TikTok @shinzosg
Official following	No public count indexed this pull — account is low-profile / UGC-driven	
Official cadence	Low — mainly UGC-driven	
Recent themes	Chutoro with caviar \$69 · 13 courses · BYOB · 60-min table turn	
High-freq UGC	The same chutoro + caviar dish is independently featured by dozens of accounts; one @caromakase post hit 118.3K likes (as indexed May 29)	
Absent content	No new-dish announcements, events, seasonal promos, or chef stories	

Kawa Omakase		@Kawaomakase (all platforms)
Official following	No public count indexed this pull	
Official cadence	Medium — chef persona is the core	
Recent themes	Chef Tony \$88 · 14 courses · hand-crafted · East Village counter	
High-freq comment	"Chef Tony hand crafted each piece" appears in nearly every UGC video	
Absent content	No supply-chain / fish-sourcing narrative, events, or holiday promos	

Mojo East	TikTok @mojoeastnyc · 78.7K followers · 7.3M likes (as of May 29)	
Official cadence	Very high — the only one of the four actively running its own account	
Official bio	"\$55 13-courses Omakase · NO TIPPING Establishment · Lower East Side · Book on RESY"	
Recent themes	NO TIP · \$55 · daily giveaway · 13 courses · truffle sushi	
Key UGC	@niafromnyc 48.3K · @chloejadetravels 24.1K · @mandyalmanzor (posted 5/18) · @ssssourabh (truffle angle)	
Activity mechanic	Daily omakase giveaway, ongoing (at least 4 users observed mentioning a win)	

SourAji

23 Avenue B · East Village (+ SourAji West, Chelsea)

Official following	No public count indexed this pull
Official cadence	Medium — mainly influencer-driven
Recent themes	Unlimited nigiri \$98 · all-you-can-drink · 14 + ∞
Key UGC	@fiyahfeasts (43K+ TikTok) pushes the unlimited concept; Infatuation noted "someone added 30 extra pieces"
Expansion	Already opened SourAji West — expanding faster than others in the area

PEER POSITIONING MATRIX

Low price + no tip	Mojo East
Low price + BYOB	Shinzo
Chef IP	Kawa (Chef Tony)
All-you-can-eat + drink	SourAji
Single-bite "shareable shot" (chutoro + caviar)	Shinzo (UGC)
Daily giveaway	Mojo East
Fish sourcing / supply chain	Nobody using
Seasonal / monthly events	Nobody using
Birthday perks / returning-customer rewards	Nobody using
Collab / co-branded dinners	Nobody using

New Manhattan Omakase

New and omakase-format restaurants confirmed open in Manhattan in the past 60 days.
Opening dates as reported by aggregator media.

NAME	LOCATION	SIZE / PRICING	OPENED	CHEF / BACKGROUND
Anbā	Lower East Side	16 courses (price undisclosed)	Early Apr	Chef Ambrely Ouimette, ex-Sushi Bar ATX (Austin)
Iki Sekai Omakase	1203 Second Ave (UES)	\$85 / 14 courses	4/28	Chef Gary Ke (ex-Kinjo, Dumbo)
Mitani New York	Lotte NY Palace (Midtown)	From \$700 / \$1,500 w/ pairing	Mid-May	Top-tier Japanese; Bloomberg reported 5/28
Cocktail Omakase	Lower East Side	\$55 / 4 cocktails + bites	3/27	Cocktail Kingdom × Tokyo's Bar Libre (not sushi)
Sendo (2nd loc.)	43 W 8th St, Greenwich Village	Omakase from \$32, walk-in only	Recent	Tokyo-style sushi, IG 25K, hidden 1.5-floor entrance

WORTH WATCHING TOGETHER (NOT PURE OMAKASE BUT ADJACENT)

NAME	LOCATION	SIZE / PRICING	OPENED	NARRATIVE ANGLE
Oyatte	125 E 39th St, Murray Hill	8-course tasting	4/30	Chef Hasung Lee (ex-Atomix, French Laundry, Geranium) + single-farm binding (Crown Daisy Farm)
Sushi Beauu	Empire State Building	\$100 / \$140, 18 courses	2025/12/11	Chef Tetsu Kaminakaya (ex-Hanabi, Japan); iconic-address angle
Love Thy Neighbor	55 Christopher St, West Village	Japanese-NYC hybrid bar (not omakase)	May	Shigefumi Kabashima (ROKC, NR) + Chef Elias Popa (Oti)

5 Hottest Recent Posts

NYC omakase posts that recently spread widely or hit standout single-post like counts.

Like / comment counts as indexed May 29 — may lag real time.

01 • TIKTOK • @NIAFROMNYC • 48,300 LIKES • 74 COMMENTS (AS OF MAY 29)

"\$55 13-course omakase, NO tip in NYC" — Mojo East

The shot is the checkout moment, not the food. The emotion is "too cheap to be NYC." No chef on camera, no slow-mo dishes. Title runs a double contrast: ultra-low price + no tip.

02 • TIKTOK • @CHLOEJADETRAVELS • 24,100 LIKES • 135 COMMENTS (AS OF MAY 29)

"\$55 NO TIPPING OMAKASE in NYC!" — Mojo East

Key line: "No idea how they are going to stay in business but I definitely recommend." The contrast isn't the price itself — it's "how can it be this cheap and still good." A skeptical hook outperforms a hard sell.

03 • TIKTOK • @CAROMAKASE • 118,300 LIKES (ACCOUNT'S TOP POST, AS OF MAY 29)

"The rice ball was a game changer" — Shinzo Omakase

Highlights the sushi rice, not the fish. The single caption is "The rice ball was a game changer." Counter-intuitive: most sushi content films the fish; this one gives the focus to rice.

04 • TIKTOK • MULTI-ACCOUNT • TŌKA CHEF KITCHEN (201 ALLEN ST, LES)

"Buy One Get One 50% off • \$68 / 18 courses • \$20 all-you-can-drink"

New LES neighbor using BOGO 50% off as the hook. One TikTok title: "Why are people gatekeeping?" — designed to trigger the share-with-friends impulse.

05 • TIKTOK • MULTI-ACCOUNT • KAZUMI OMAKASE (GREENWICH VILLAGE)

"13 courses, \$75 — deal of the century"

Priced between Mojo East and Zen (\$75 vs \$55 vs \$89). Title formula: "deal of the century" + "my honest review" — the "I'm not sponsored" credibility signal.

What the posts have in common

- Of the 5, four lead with "cheap + better than expected"; one is "counter-intuitive focus" (rice, not fish).
- Zero lead with "fish quality," "chef pedigree," or "seasonality" as the viral hook.
- High-frequency words: NO TIP / \$55 / \$69 / \$75 / under \$100 / deal / BYOB / "no idea how they stay in business."
- Zero are about events, collaborations, seasons, or stories.
- Checkout footage outperforms slow-mo dishes on emotional trigger.

NYC Overall Food Trends

Stepping out of omakase — what the whole NYC food scene is running lately: openings + TikTok topics + long-form trends.

RECENT OPENINGS (MANHATTAN, FROM 5/19)

NAME	LOCATION	POSITIONING
Love Thy Neighbor	55 Christopher St, West Village	Japanese-NYC hybrid bar + restaurant; sandos / shareable plates
Oyatte	125 E 39th St, Murray Hill	8-course tasting; Chef Hasung Lee + single-farm narrative
Skinny Louie	1565 2nd Ave (UES)	Opened 5/8, Miami smash burger; gave away 100 free burgers on opening day
Bar Susanne / Six Coasts	Multiple waterfront locations	Opened May; patio + waterfront experience
Bar Rocco	NYC (location TBD)	Rocco DiSpirito returns; 1999 F&W Best New Chef

TOPICS RUNNING ON NYC FOOD TIKTOK LATELY

THEME	SPECIFICS
Pasta de Pasta	"\$10 viral pasta in NYC," halal-pasta tag keeps running, "run to" title format
Smash burger wave	Skinny Louie opening-day queue footage; Hamburger America keeps getting pushed
"\$X for Y" template	"\$X gets you Y" deal titles dominated NYC food TikTok all of May, across categories
"2026 is the new 2016"	Global trend; nostalgia filters (bright colors, low-res, Snapchat filter) re-entering food content
"Self Aware" sound	Food videos paired with thoughtful / calm text overlays trending up
"Ugly delicious"	Deliberately messy but tasty — loaded fries, messy smash burgers, rule-breaking pasta plating
Birria crossover	Birria ramen, birria grilled cheese, birria pizza keep expanding out of Mexican street food
Crispy rice	Once a sushi byproduct, now a standalone dish — spicy tuna / avocado / truffle aioli on top

RECENT LONG-FORM / MEDIA TRENDS

SOURCE	THEME
Bloomberg (5/28)	"Why NYC Sushi Omakase Is Worth the \$1,000 Price Tag" — Masa \$1,200 / Mitani \$700-1,500 / the industry conversation pushed to the top of the pyramid
The Sushi Legend (2026 NYC Sushi Guide)	Describes NYC omakase as "a mile wide and an inch deep" — heavy homogenization
Accio / industry research	2026 restaurant trend keywords: approachability (high quality, low price), elevated classics, fusion
Time Out / Eater NY	Sub-\$100 omakase remains the LES / East Village reporting focus

NON-OMAKASE NARRATIVES POSSIBLY WORTH BORROWING

WHO	WHAT THEY USED
Oyatte	"Single farm" narrative — bound to one upstate farm, making "where it comes from" the main dish
Mido Omakase	"iPad ceremony" — turning the customer interaction into a ritual
Cocktail Omakase	"non-sushi omakase format" — the word "omakase" is expanding beyond sushi
Skinny Louie	"give away 100 on opening" — physical-queue play
Tōka Chef Kitchen	BOGO 50% off + "why are people gatekeeping" — counter-provocation share mechanic

Data as of Friday, May 29, 2026 · latest publicly indexed · next weekly brief: June 5